tension arose due to Ayodhya crisis, failure of Siachen talks and even attempt by Azad Kashmir force to cross border. In 1994, Indian Consulate in Karachi was closed.

During the Prime Ministership of P.V. Narasimha Rao (1991–1996) Indo-Pak relations continued to be strained following the accelerated pace of development of Pak's nuclear capability with the assistance from China and North Korea. Further, the demolition of Babri Masjid on 7 December 1992 deteriorated the relation between the two.

In 1996, when the United Front Government under I.K. Gujral came to power, Prime Minister Gujral introduced a new dimension of India's foreign policy. He introduced a concept which came to be identified as ***Gujral Doctrine***, and it was chalked with a vision to improve India's relations with her neighbour without expecting reciprocity. India tried to melt the ice by initiating the process of bilateral talks, but Pakistan under Bhutto backed out. With the assumption of office of PM by Nawaz Sharif there were certain improvements in the Indo-Pak relations. Though there was no substantial breakthrough and Kashmir remained the most contentious issue, yet both sides agreed to carry out the dialogue process.

With the assumption of Prime Ministership of A.B. Vajpayee, relations suffered due to the Pokhran explosion on 11 May 1998. Pakistan responded by nuke explosions at Chaghai on 13 May 1998. India however, again made efforts to improve the bilateral relations. Vajpayee as a part of confidence-building measure with Pakistan inaugurated a bus service in February 1999, and he himself took the inaugural bus service to visit the then Prime Minister of Pakistan, Nawaz Sharif in February at Lahore. This was followed by signing of Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) reaffirming their unilateral moratorium on further nuclear testing and spelling out their confidence-building measures. But the Kargil adventurism of Pakistan in May-June 1999 under General Musharraf disrupted the peace process. Gradually, relations showed improvement and this was followed by General Musharaff's visit to India for talks in Agra in July 2001. But the talks failed to make any notable breakthrough and even later the thaw in Indo-Pak relation continued because of Pakistan's insistence of linking Kashmir as the core issue always